MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia: Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student name and number: [ ]

Word count: Question One 688; Question Two 1,009 (including headings; excluding figures, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,697

Question One: Evaluating "Mat to Moment"

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes rather than generating reach, likes or clicks (Belch & Belch, 2021). On that test, I think our campaign is likely to meet its store-awareness objective (O3) but is weakest on the price objective (O1), which our own report ranked first (Appendix A).

Strengths

Our objectives are a clear strength. Each is tied to a diagnosed challenge and paired with a measure, with O3 benchmarked against Meta's (2020) brand-lift averages, following DAGMAR's principle that objectives must be specific and measurable (Colley, 1961). Integration is also strong. Table 3 of our report holds the line, set and sign-off constant across ten touchpoints, and consistent repetition builds the recall and trust on which brand equity depends (Keller, 2001). Because store location is a simple fact that can be learned through the peripheral route (Petty et al., 1983), repeating it around the three stores makes the 10-point O3 lift plausible. Our localisation was also sound: standardisation brings efficiency (Levitt, 1983), but perceived localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019), so we kept Alo's global identity but gave the voice to Sydney instructors. The pre/post survey with a Melbourne control group supplies the counterfactual that observational measures lack (Gordon et al., 2019).

Weaknesses

Audience. Segment A suits Alo because its members buy activewear as an expression of identity (Belk, 1988; Escalas & Bettman, 2005). However, it is also the segment most stretched by money: more than half of Gen Z and Millennials have delayed major life decisions because of financial pressure (Deloitte, 2026). At A$100–200 per item, Alo is closer to "masstige" than to true luxury,

and new-luxury buyers trade up in a few emotionally important categories while trading down elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We followed Kapferer and Bastien's (2009) luxury rule of meaning over justification. Yet consumers judge value on quality, emotional and social dimensions as well as price (Sweeney & Soutar, 2001), and guilt makes indulgent purchases less likely unless the context lets people justify them (Okada, 2005). The audience was right, but our message never confronted its defining tension.

Message. "Mat to Moment" is clear and single-minded, but creativity must be novel as well as relevant (Smith & Yang, 2004), and our line describes the category rather than the brand: athleisure is defined as clothing designed for both exercise and general use (Merriam-Webster, n.d.). Lululemon could run the same line, so pre-testing should check brand attribution (Belch & Belch, 2021). The central-route proof for price also sits mainly in Sanctuary Sessions, which our report admits reach "hundreds rather than thousands". That is 22% of the budget spent on a mechanism that cannot shift a population-level survey measure. Most of Segment A would meet it only as filmed content while scrolling, where peripherally formed attitudes are weaker (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986).

Channels. We spread A$250,000 across ten touchpoint types, with only 40% in paid media. Ben & Jerry's 2025 Australian Snapchat campaign shows the alternative: concentrating its spend on a single platform, it reached more than 3 million Australians and lifted ad awareness by 13 points and action intent among 21–24-year-olds by 7 points (Snap Inc., 2025). Persuasion needs higher frequency than awareness (Belch & Belch, 2021), and spreading a small budget risks leaving each channel short of it. About 45% of spend also went to creators, sessions and PR, which carry less control and greater reputation risk (Campbell & Farrell, 2020), and the launch relies on a single lead creator.

Measurement. With about 400 respondents per wave, our survey reliably detects changes of roughly five points, yet O1 and O2 target six, so a smaller real shift could be missed. A platform brand-lift study with a randomised holdout, as Ben & Jerry's used, would give stronger causal evidence than observational comparison (Gordon et al., 2019).

Improvements

Three changes would raise the campaign's likely effectiveness. First, deliver the price argument openly and at scale rather than relying on events. Second, concentrate paid media on Instagram and

TikTok and measure it with randomised brand lift. Third, pre-test the proposition for brand attribution before launch. Question Two develops them.

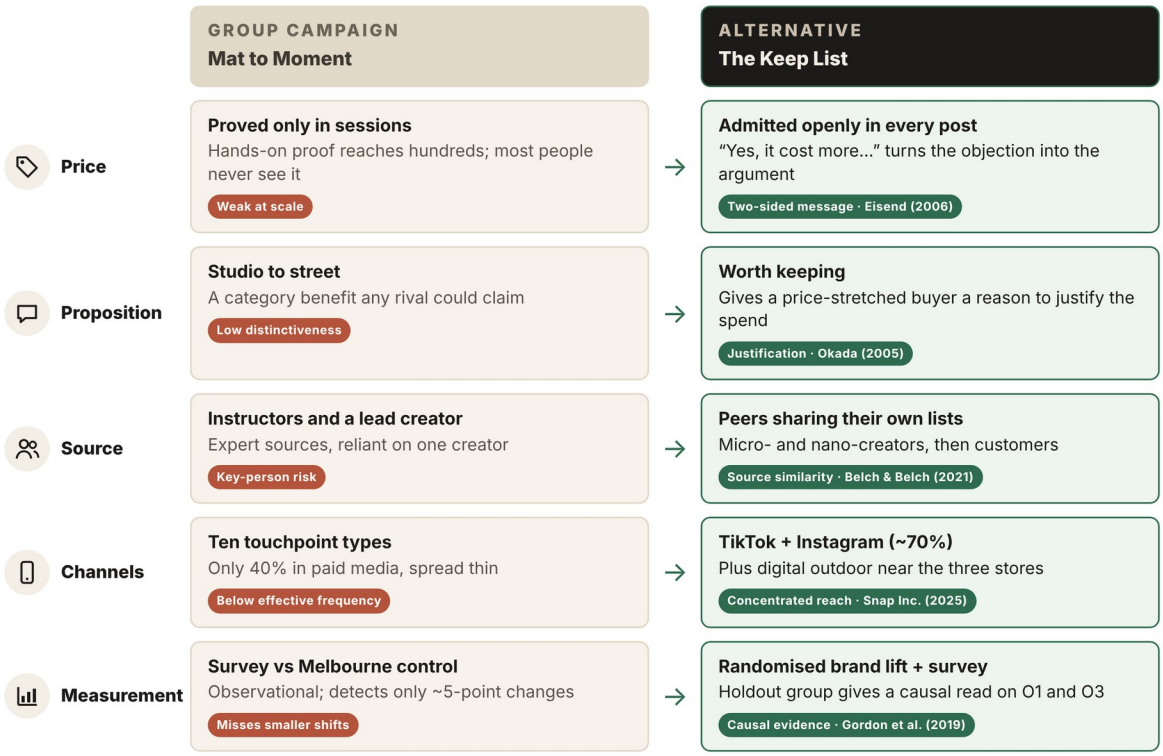
Question Two: An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

Audience and Insight

I would retain Segment A, because its fit with Alo still holds (Belk, 1988; Inside Retail, 2026). What changes is how the campaign treats their money. Under financial pressure, consumers trade down in some categories and delay major decisions (Deloitte, 2026; Silverstein & Fiske, 2003), but this audience does not cut back quietly. In 2024, “loud budgeting”, openly saying what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice rather than lack (Axios, 2024). The insight: Segment A is cutting back out loud, and what they keep says who they are. The campaign’s job is to make Alo one of the things they keep. Figure 1 summarises the changes.

Figure 1

How The Keep List Differs From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses drawn from the Question One evaluation; theory tags show the main source justifying each change.

Why It Should Be More Effective

Message. The original campaign was one-sided. The Keep List is two-sided: it admits that Alo costs more, then explains why the trade is worth making (Appendix C). Two-sided messages increase perceived source credibility (Eisend, 2006), consumers increasingly demand brand transparency (Sprout Social, 2018), and refuting an objection in advance protects beliefs against later counter-arguments (McGuire, 1961) such as “Lululemon is cheaper”. It also supplies the missing justification (Okada, 2005). Mental accounting explains how: consumers assign spending to separate mental budgets (Thaler, 1999), and setting Alo beside cancelled takeaway moves it from a “fashion splurge” account into “things I use every day”. It remains a rational value appeal (Belch & Belch, 2021) without discounting, which raises price sensitivity over time (Mela et al., 1997).

Persuasion route. Under the Elaboration Likelihood Model, central processing requires both motivation and ability (Petty et al., 1983). A five-line list is read in seconds while scrolling yet carries an argument, bringing central-route persuasion to paid-social scale rather than to sessions reaching hundreds (Appendix B). This targets O1 directly.

Source and distinctiveness. Lists come from Sydney micro- and nano-creators and, later, customers. Smaller creators tend to achieve higher engagement and closer trust than large ones (Campbell & Farrell, 2020), and similarity to the audience is part of source attractiveness (Belch & Belch, 2021). frank green shows the model working: customer-made TikTok content surged before the brand even had an account (TikTok for Business, n.d.). “Keep List” is also an ownable mechanic rather than a category benefit, so it should be easier to link to Alo (Sharp, 2010).

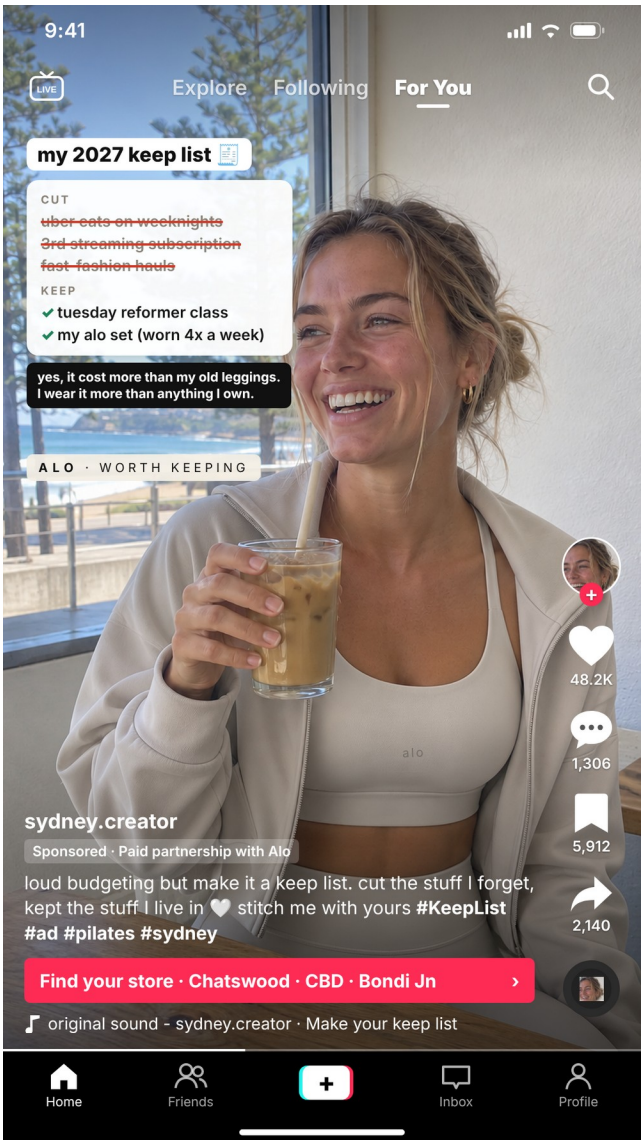
Channels and integration. About 70% of working media moves to TikTok and Instagram; Australian Android users spend about 74 minutes a day on TikTok alone (Kemp, 2026), and concentrating spend follows the Ben & Jerry’s example (Snap Inc., 2025). Creator posts are boosted as paid ads, so paid, owned and earned media carry the same content (Stephen & Galak, 2012). A Stitch template invites users to post their own #KeepList, creating earned discovery content. Digital outdoor near the three stores shows consented customer lists, and staff hand buyers a “keep card” with care instructions. One mechanic therefore runs through every touchpoint (Appendix D). Sanctuary Sessions and Spotify are dropped to fund reach, and the fabric trial moves to in-store try-ons.

Measurement. An A/B pre-test (Belch & Belch, 2021; Appendix E) compares the two-sided list with a one-sided version on brand attribution and agreement that “Alo is worth paying more for”. In flight, a platform brand-lift study with a holdout measures O1 and O3 causally, and social listening tracks whether comments read the campaign as honest or as rationalising overspending.

Creative Mock-up

Figure 2

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame; the person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used]: “Photorealistic

vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral 'bone' colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic): "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Figure 2 is a TikTok in-feed creator post for the first burst.

Message. The on-screen list is the argument: three things cut, two kept. The on-screen admission ("yes, it cost more than my old leggings") makes it two-sided, and the sign-off "Alo. Worth keeping." attaches the justification to the brand.

Imagery. A woman in her mid-twenties laughs over an iced latte in a beachside Sydney café after class. Natural light, unretouched skin and a handheld look suit the platform and Gen Z's preference for authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018).

Design. The list imitates a phone Notes app, a format read as personal rather than polished. Alo's neutral palette, wordmark and sticker maintain brand linkage. The "Sponsored · Paid partnership" label sits directly under the handle and #ad in the caption, because advertising must be clearly distinguishable (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021), native formats can obscure that content is advertising (Wojdynski & Evans, 2016), and 96% of fashion influencers reviewed had posts raising consumer-law concerns (Australian Competition and Consumer Commission [ACCC], 2023).

Call to action. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction to drive visits (O4), while "Make your keep list" invites Stitches that extend earned reach.

AI limitations. I used AI to generate the photograph and compose the TikTok frame. The image is believable but too polished for phone footage, and audiences tend to see artificial personas as

uncanny and “authentically fake” (Lou et al., 2023), undermining authenticity. The tool also cannot reproduce Alo’s garments or logo, so the wordmark was added afterwards. In execution, a real creator wears real Alo product, and every list must reflect her genuine trade-offs, because scripted claims presented as personal experience would be misleading (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

Compared with the original, The Keep List puts the price argument in front of the whole segment, costs less per person persuaded and can be measured causally. It has three limitations. First, financial hardship is a recognised source of consumer vulnerability (ACCC, 2021), and manipulation means undermining people’s normal decision-making (Sher, 2011), so lists celebrate what people cut and never present the set as a necessity. Second, loud budgeting peaked in 2024 and may feel dated by 2027, so the campaign uses “Keep List” rather than the trend’s name. Third, talking about money risks diluting Alo’s prestige (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009), so Alo never discusses price in its own voice; peers do. On balance, I expect a stronger O1 result than the original, a similar O3 result and an O4 result that still depends on the store experience.

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Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Communication Objectives

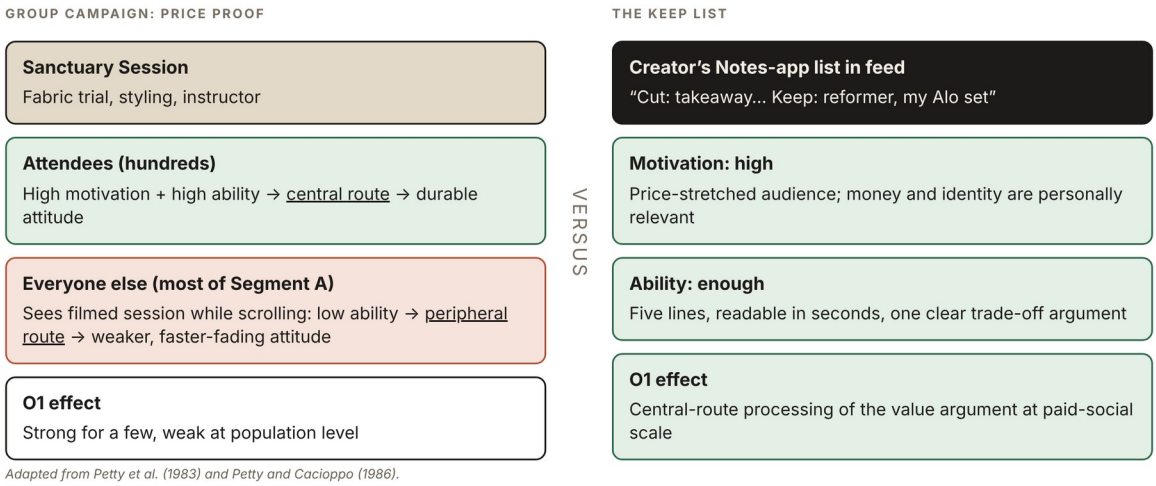
Objective	Main mechanism in group plan	Evaluation (theory)	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25%→35%)	One fact repeated on outdoor, audio and geo-targeted social near the stores	Simple fact suits low-involvement, peripheral processing (Petty et al., 1983); repetition and consistency build memory (Keller, 2001)	**Likely** Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12%→18%)	Sydney instructors and creators re-encode the LA brand locally	Localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019); source similarity aids persuasion (Belch & Belch, 2021)	**Possible** Target near survey detection limit (~5 pts)
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15%→21%)	Hands-on proof in Sanctuary Sessions; cost-per-wear carousel	Central route reaches only "hundreds"; most see filmed proof peripherally, forming weaker attitudes (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); price tension never confronted (Okada, 2005)	**At risk** Top-priority objective, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8%→11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour moves least; 3-pt change undetectable by survey, so traffic data needed (Gordon et al., 2019)	**Uncertain** Depends on O1 and store experience

Note. Agency evaluation applying Colley (1961), Petty et al. (1983), Petty and Cacioppo (1986), Keller (2001), Sichtmann et al. (2019), Okada (2005) and Gordon et al. (2019). Supports Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Elaboration Likelihood Model Applied to the Price Argument: Group Campaign Versus The Keep List

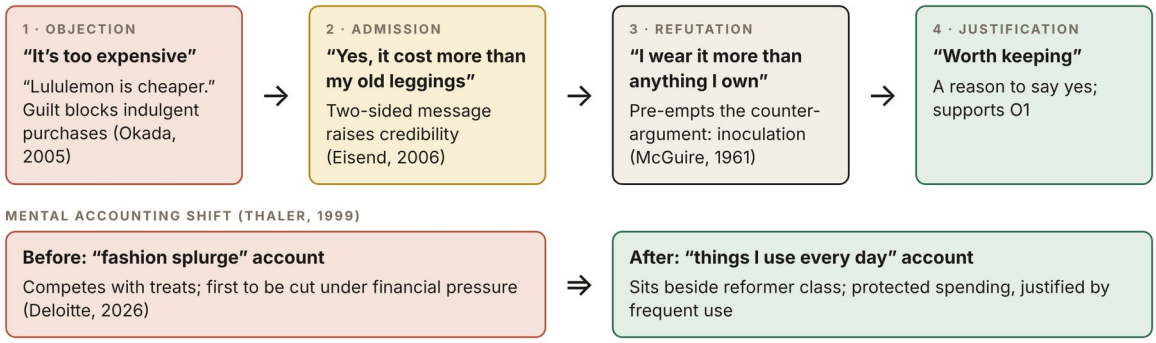


Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and Petty and Cacioppo (1986). Supports the persuasion-route argument in Question Two.

Appendix C

Figure C1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting in The Keep List



Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Integration of Paid, Owned, Earned and In-Store Touchpoints Around One Mechanic



Note. Adapted from Stephen and Galak (2012) and Court et al. (2009).

Appendix E

Figure E1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan for The Keep List



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).